

Exhibit I: Records Retention and Destruction Policy

Companion document to the BCOC Bylaws 2026 Amendment Package

Status: Proposed 2026 · **Vote required:** Yes (Agree / Do Not Agree / Agree with Suggested Edits)

This exhibit is incorporated by reference into Article XII, Section 1 of the BCOC Bylaws.

Records Retention and Destruction Policy and Procedure

Subject: Records Retention and Destruction Policy and Procedure

Objective: To establish a consistent framework for the creation, retention, storage, protection, retrieval, and lawful destruction of BCOC records.

Purpose: The purpose of this Policy is to ensure that the Black Chief Officers Committee (BCOC) maintains complete and accurate records, preserves documents necessary for legal, financial, governance, and operational purposes, and disposes of records in an orderly manner consistent with applicable law and sound nonprofit governance practices.

Section 1. Scope and Applicability

This Policy applies to all Executive Board members, officers, appointed officials, committee members, employees, contractors, volunteers, and any other persons acting on behalf of the BCOC who create, receive, store, or manage organizational records in paper or electronic form.

Section 2. Definition of Organizational Records

Organizational records include, but are not limited to, governing documents, minutes, agendas, financial records, tax filings, audit materials, contracts, insurance records, membership rosters, conference records, committee reports, correspondence, grants, publications, website and social media archives, and other records created or maintained in connection with BCOC business.

Section 3. Ownership and Custody of Records

All organizational records are the property of the BCOC and shall be maintained in the custody of the appropriate officer or designee. Official governance records shall be maintained by the Recording Secretary unless otherwise assigned by the Executive Board. Official financial records shall be maintained by the Treasurer, subject to access and oversight requirements established by the Bylaws and Board policy.

Section 4. Retention Standards

The BCOC shall retain records for such periods as are necessary to satisfy legal, fiscal, historical, administrative, and operational requirements.

1. Records of permanent value, including the Articles of Incorporation, Bylaws, IRS determination

letters, annual reports, annual conference minutes, Executive Board minutes, tax returns, audit reports, and intellectual property registrations, shall be retained permanently.

2. The following records should generally be retained for at least seven (7) years unless a longer period is required by law, contract, audit, litigation hold, or Board direction: bank statements, general ledgers, supporting accounting documentation, invoices, receipts, contracts after expiration, payroll and vendor records, insurance records after expiration, and conference financial files.
3. Routine correspondence, drafts, duplicate copies, logistical planning documents, and transitory administrative materials may be destroyed when no longer needed, provided that no litigation hold, audit requirement, public inquiry, or Board directive requires longer retention.

Section 5. Storage and Protection

Records shall be stored in a manner reasonably designed to protect confidentiality, integrity, accessibility, and continuity of operations. Electronic records should, when feasible, be stored in a centralized cloud-based or other secure repository approved by the Executive Board, with appropriate access controls, backup procedures, and succession planning for turnover of officers.

Section 6. Destruction of Records

When the applicable retention period has expired, records may be destroyed in the ordinary course of business, provided that destruction is carried out securely and in a manner appropriate to the sensitivity of the information. Paper records containing confidential or financial information shall be shredded or otherwise rendered unreadable. Electronic records shall be deleted in a manner reasonably intended to prevent unauthorized recovery.

Section 7. Litigation Hold and Suspension of Destruction

If the BCOC becomes aware of pending or reasonably anticipated litigation, audit, investigation, subpoena, claim, or other matter requiring preservation of records, all ordinary destruction of relevant records shall be suspended immediately. The Chairperson, in consultation with legal counsel when appropriate, may issue a litigation hold directing the preservation of specified categories of records until further notice.

Section 8. Responsibility and Compliance

Each person covered by this Policy is responsible for complying with it and for preserving records within his or her custody that relate to BCOC business. Knowingly destroying, altering, concealing, or removing records in violation of this Policy or a litigation hold may result in disciplinary action and any other corrective action authorized by the Bylaws or applicable law.

Section 9. Review and Updates

The Executive Board may review and administratively update this Policy from time to time to reflect operational needs, technology changes, or legal developments, provided such updates do not conflict with the Bylaws. Material changes may be incorporated into the exhibit record maintained with the official BCOC governance documents.

[OPEN THE FEEDBACK FORM TO VOTE](#)

Black Chief Officers' Committee · Prepared for feedback prior to the Executive Board vote and member vote in August 2026.